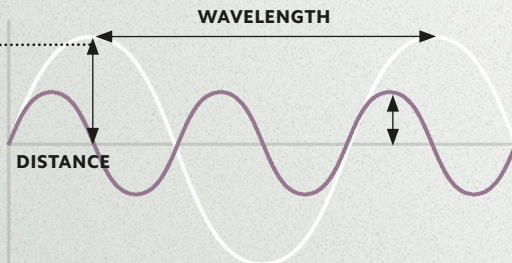


AMPLITUDE

The amplitude of a wave is the maximum displacement (distance) a field or particle oscillates from its central equilibrium position.



Wave essentials

A wave's frequency is the number of times it oscillates per second, while wavelength is the distance covered by one complete oscillation.

Interference

When the crests of two waves of the same frequency line up, they form a wave with greater amplitude (called constructive interference). Destructive interference occurs when the troughs of one wave partially or entirely cancel out the peaks of another.

